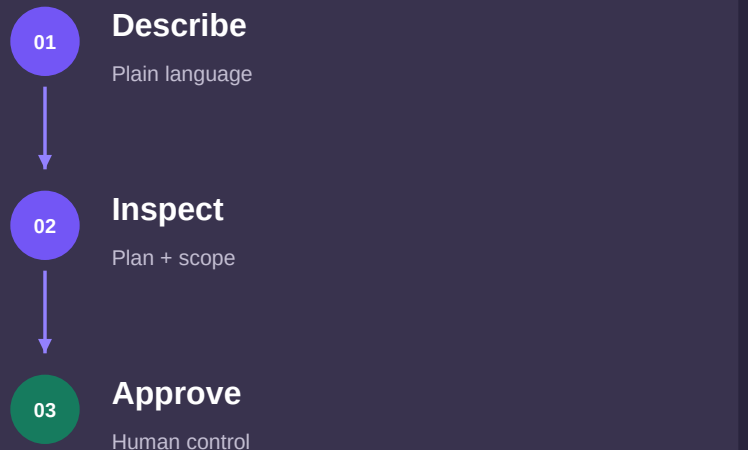
Pucho.ai

# Designing trust into AI automation

From "build me an automation" to "I understand what will happen."

A complete UX concept for a non-technical operations lead: discovery, strategy, information architecture, flows, wireframes, UI, clickthrough prototype, and a ready-to-run validation plan.



00 / BRIEF

# Design the first successful automation

A non-technical operations lead wants a repeatable lead briefing without handing over unchecked control.

CHALLENGE

## Turn intent into action

Translate plain-language intent into a reviewable workflow, then make access, decisions, and consequences clear.

SCENARIO

## Morning lead triage

Gather new CRM leads each weekday, summarize them, apply a team fit rule, and prepare a sales-channel message. Uncertain items pause for a person.

SCOPE

## Concept, not production

Fictional records. No live integration, production capability claim, or participant evidence is implied.

REQUIRED ARTIFACTS FROM THE MENTORSHIP BRIEF

| DISCOVER | DEFINE | STRUCTURE | DESIGN | VALIDATE |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 5 interview questions + audit | Persona + JTBD + HMW | IA + user/task flows | 4 wireframes + 2 screens | Prototype + 3 tasks |

DESIGN COMPLETE

PRIMARY RESEARCH PENDING

The concept, artifacts, and runnable prototype are complete. Human interviews and usability sessions remain a real-world next step; findings are not invented.

01 / DISCOVER

# Start with evidence, then label the gaps

Public product pages explain the category. They do not tell us how a first-time operator thinks or behaves.

SECONDARY REVIEW

## Product context

Reviewed Pucho public pages and docs on agents, workflows, integrations, knowledge, approvals, and run visibility.

CATEGORY SCAN

## Competitor patterns

Reviewed official Zapier, Make, and n8n pages for workflow structure, AI placement, access/approval, inspection, and recovery.

PRIMARY RESEARCH

## Not conducted

No participant interviews or usability sessions were run. Persona and user needs are hypotheses, not findings.

FIVE QUESTIONS FOR FIRST INTERVIEWS

1. Walk me through the last time you checked and prioritized new leads.
2. Which parts repeat, and where do you use judgment?
3. What information is safe or relevant to share with your team?
4. What happened the last time you tried to automate a task?
5. What would you need to see before an AI summary could post?

**Status: desk review complete; primary discovery pending.**

**Separate facts, hypotheses, design decisions, and validation.**

# Audit interaction models, not feature counts

Official public pages were reviewed; this is a desk scan, not a hands-on comparative usability study.

| PRODUCT | PUBLIC PATTERN | STRENGTH TO LEARN FROM | OPENING FOR THIS CONCEPT |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Pucho** | Agents, workflows, tools, knowledge, integrations, and human checkpoints share one platform story. | Connect intent to tools and execution without losing context. | Make sources, decisions, and writes visible in an outcome-led route. |
| **Zapier** | AI can sit inside structured workflows; approval can gate consequential continuation. | Place approval next to the action that needs it. | Separate preparing a message from posting it. |
| **Make** | Scenarios connect app modules; docs distinguish fixed, AI-assisted, and agent scenarios. | Represent sequence and conditions visually. | Show a short readable plan before visual logic. |
| **n8n** | Step inputs/outputs, logs, replay, tool limits, and human review are emphasized. | Make runs inspectable and recoverable. | Explain the next safe action before technical trace details. |

**DESIGN OPENING** Help the user predict the next action, understand its scope, and recover without needing a workflow engineer.

# Meet Nisha, the business operator

Proto-persona grounded in the assignment scenario; validate with operations practitioners before treating it as representative.



## NISHA

Operations lead

15-PERSON TEAM

**"I know the process. I do not want to become an automation engineer."**

GOAL

### Useful morning view

Prioritize new leads and share the right context with sales.

FRICTION HYPOTHESIS

### Technical choices arrive early

Triggers, app permissions, model settings, and nodes can obscure the outcome.

NEED

### Confidence before Run

See what data is read, what AI judges, and what action follows.

SUCCESS LOOKS LIKE

### Easy to inspect and edit

Change, pause, or recover without relying on an engineer.

Comfortable with spreadsheets, Slack, and CRM records. Scenario assumption.

02 / DEFINE

# The job is to automate an outcome safely

Separate the practical job from the emotional and control needs that shape trust.

JOBS TO BE DONE

**When new leads arrive during the work week, I want a concise, prioritized summary in our sales channel, so I can follow up promptly without checking every record - while knowing the system uses approved data and pauses when judgment is uncertain.**

FUNCTIONAL

### Turn repetition into routine

Collect, summarize, apply team criteria, prepare a digest.

EMOTIONAL

### Feel informed, not surprised

Understand why a lead was highlighted and what happens next.

CONTROL

### Choose the point of action

Inspect scope, approve writes, pause, and recover.

PROBLEM STATEMENT

AI builders can surface technical choices before users understand outcomes, data access, or consequences. Operators need a useful first workflow without guessing at architecture or surrendering control.

HOW MIGHT WE

**Help an operations lead express a routine in plain language, inspect the AI plan and access, and test it before it posts?**

02 / DEFINE

# Five principles shape every screen

Use these as design filters. Each one maps to a decision the prototype must make visible.

01

### Intent before configuration

Start with the work; reveal system choices after the plan.

02

### Explain before execute

Name source, decision, and action. Show evidence, not hidden chain-of-thought.

03

### Preview before commit

Show a sample result and its boundaries before a live run.

04

### Human control at critical moments

Separate reading, drafting, and posting; require approval for consequential writes.

05

### Recover without fear

Pause safely, explain failure, and make retry/edit/reject clear.

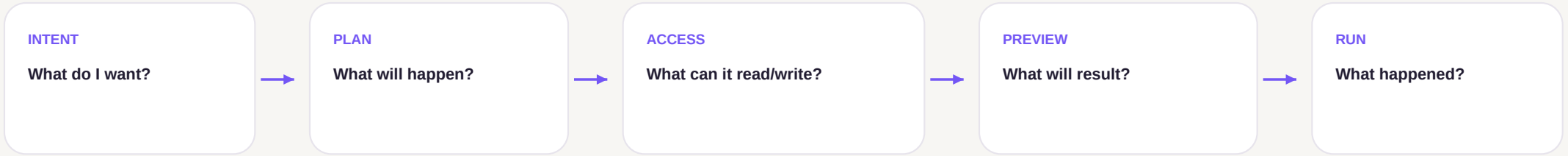
TRUST QUESTION

**What is happening, why, and what can I do about it?**

03 / STRUCTURE

# Organize around the user outcome

Keep navigation stable, then guide setup through a predictable sequence.




PRIMARY NAVIGATION

| | |
|---|---|
| Build | Start or revise a workflow |
| Workflows | Drafts, active schedules, versions |
| Approvals | Items waiting for a person |
| Connections | Apps and granted scopes |
| Knowledge | Team rules and reference |
| Runs | History, status, recovery |

**IA decision: keep setup steps visible; let users revisit permissions and run details.**

# A guided conversation from words to workflow

The key transition is the AI proposal becoming human understanding.

1. **Describe outcome** — Plain language + timing
2. **Review plan** — Edit steps + rules
3. **Inspect access** — Read/write scope
4. **Preview sample** — Output + limits
5. **Run test** — No live schedule
6. **Approve or pause** — Human decision

## CONTROL CHECKPOINTS

**BEFORE ACCESS**

Show fields, app, and reason.

**BEFORE ACTIVATION**

Preview trigger, schedule, sample, and write.

**AT UNCERTAINTY**

Pause; never infer permission.

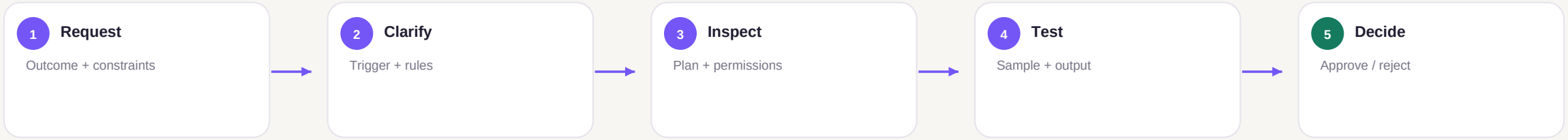
**AFTER ACTION**

Log change, approver, and undo path.

**Default: AI drafts and summarizes; the user grants access and approves a consequential post.**

# Task flow includes safe exits

Keep the happy path short; make edge cases understandable and recoverable.




**No connection**
Stay in draft; show scope; connect only after review.

**Missing data**
Ask a question or mark the lead for human review.

**Duplicate**
Skip safely; show the matching record.

**Tool failure**
Preserve completed work; reconnect and retry one step.

**Wrong output**
Edit, preview again, reject, or pause.

**No silent retries, duplicate writes, or unexpected messages. Preserve state and show a safe next action.**

04 / DESIGN

# Four wireframes answer four user questions

Low-fidelity structure focuses on what the user needs to understand at each step.

01 / ASK

### What do I want?



Outcome prompt
Suggested examples
Trigger summary
Build plan

LOW FIDELITY

02 / PLAN

### What will happen?



Ordered steps
AI vs rule labels
Assumptions to confirm
Edit each step

LOW FIDELITY

03 / REVIEW

### What can I control?



Fields read
Action written
Approval point
Confirm scope

LOW FIDELITY

04 / RUN

### What happened?



Step status
What changed
What is waiting
Retry / pause / undo

LOW FIDELITY

04 / DESIGN

# AI proposes; the person owns the decision

Show the system boundary in words the user can act on.

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| AI | **Interpret intent** | Draft trigger, steps, and assumptions. |
| USER | **Confirm the plan** | Edit criteria, schedule, and uncertainty behaviour. |
| USER | **Grant access** | Choose field scope and destination. |
| AI | **Prepare routine work** | Summarize, classify, create a private draft. |
| [illegible] | **Approve consequential action** | Post, reject, edit, pause, or request context |

**EXPLAINABLE OUTPUT**

Show source fields, rule applied, confidence band, and next action - never hidden chain-of-thought.

**AUTONOMY SPECTRUM**

Auto for reversible work; review uncertainty; approve writes; block restricted actions.

# A calm visual system for a complex task

Let the workflow carry the visual interest. Keep status and risk distinct from decoration.

## COLOR TOKENS

| | |
|---|---|
| PRIMARY | #7356F5 |
| INK | #211C31 |
| SURFACE | #F7F6F3 |
| SUCCESS | #167B5E |
| REVIEW | #A56714 |
| RISK | #B85068 |

## TYPE, SPACE, COMPONENTS

**Aa**

### Display / headline

System sans / 30, 22, 16, 12, 10

8 px 16 px 24 px 32 px

**BUTTON HIERARCHY**

Primary Quiet

**STATUS IS EXPLICIT**

READY REVIEW

**SPACING + SHAPE**

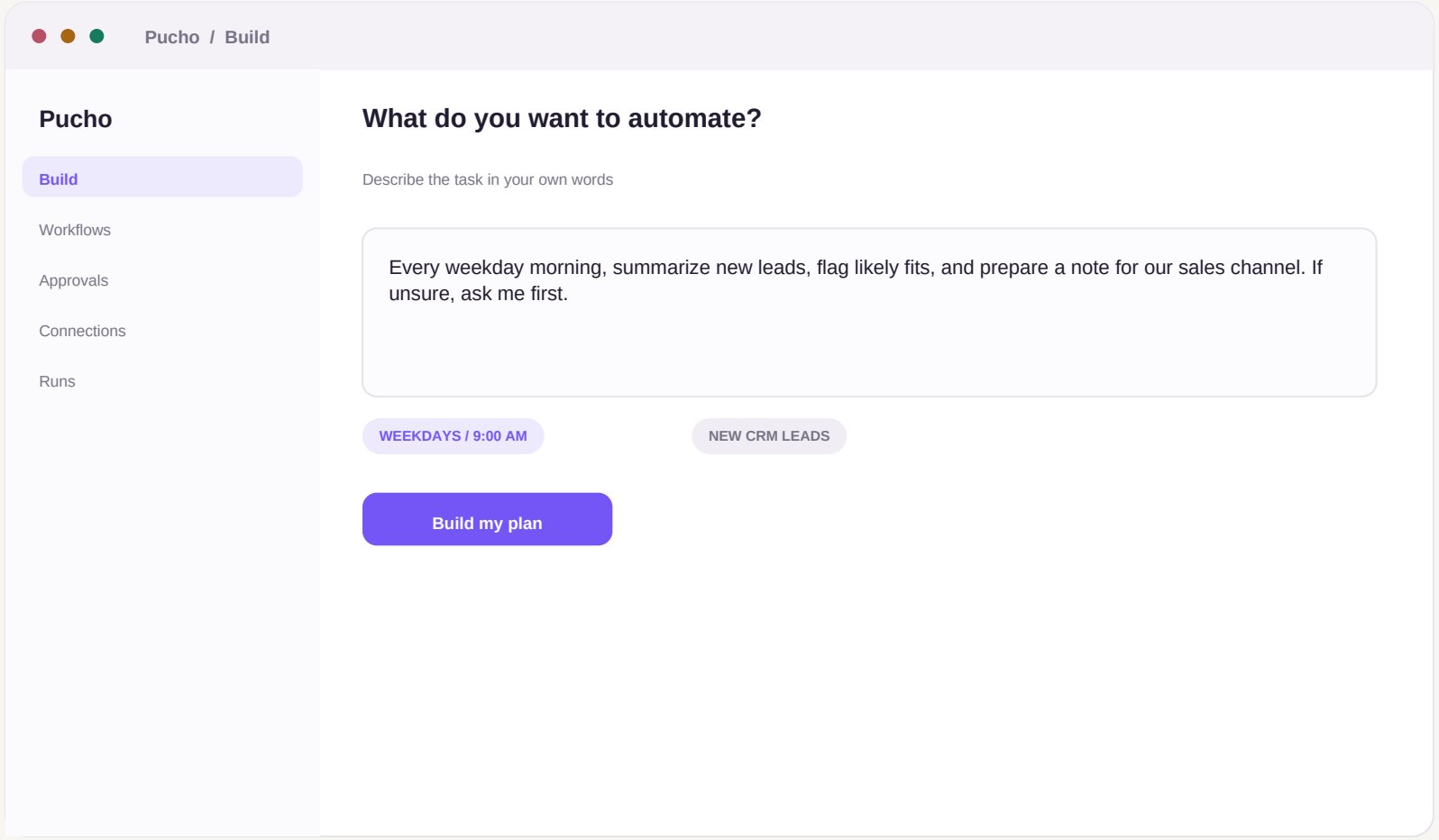
8 px rhythm / 12 px radius / 1 px border

## ACCESSIBILITY INTENT

- Never use color as the only status cue.
- Pair icon and label for action state.
- Keep product UI body copy at 12-14 px.
- Use focus states, keyboard access, semantic buttons.

# Concept 01 - Ask, do not configure

Start with the business outcome. Let AI translate it into system language.




WHY THIS DESIGN

## Outcome language first

The user describes the work. No need to choose a node, model, API, or app before Pucho proposes a path.

SAFETY CUE

## No app changes yet

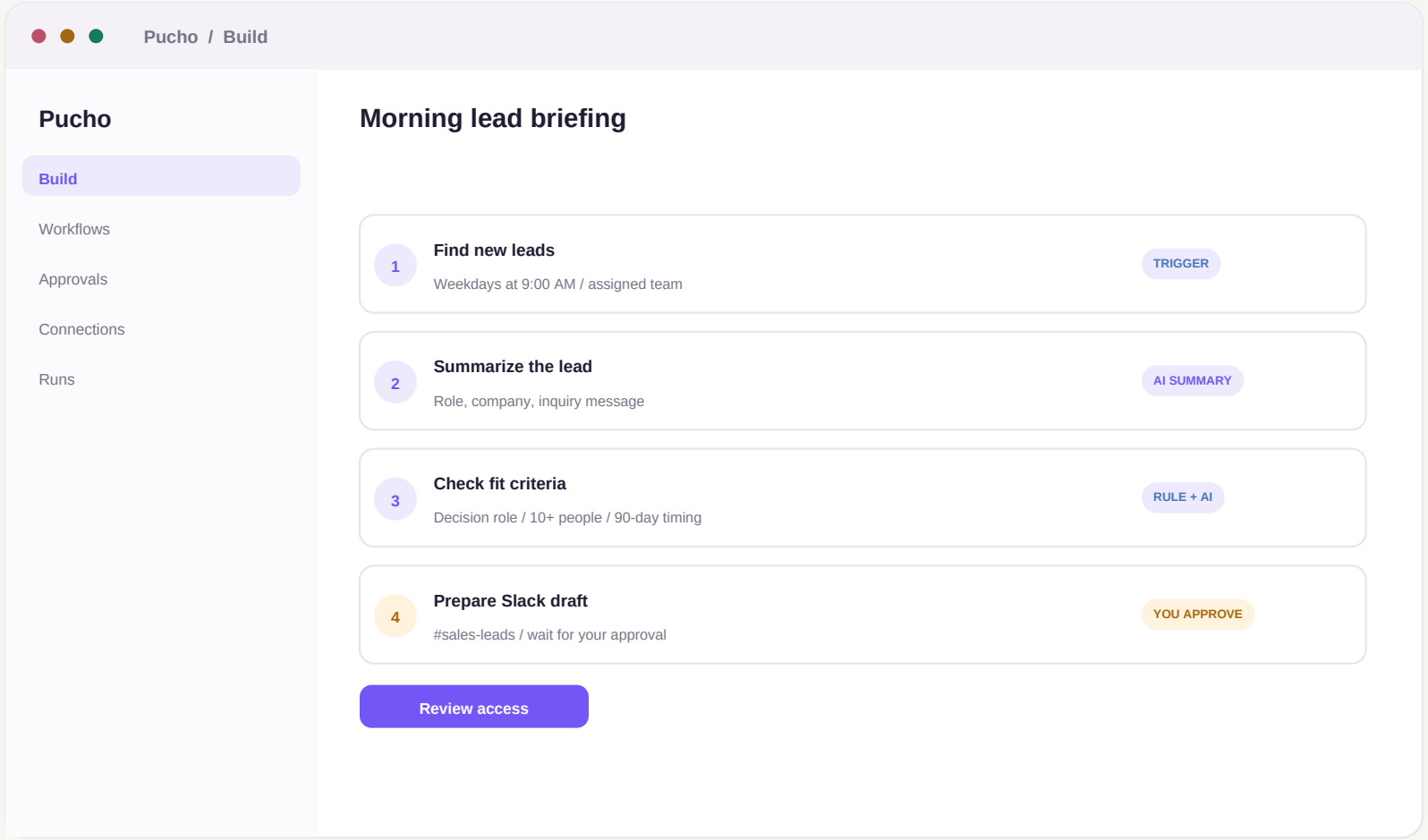
A persistent draft state tells the user that setup is private; no connection or write has happened.

PRIMARY ACTION

**Build my plan**

# Concept 02 - Make the plan inspectable

Show what the system inferred, what each step does, and where the human remains in control.




TRUST CUES

## Scope + decision labels

Each row separates trigger, AI summary, rule, and approval. Data and writes are named before access is granted.

EXPLAINABILITY

## Evidence, not hidden thoughts

Show fields, criteria, confidence, and next action. Keep internal model reasoning private.

EDIT CRITERIA

05 / INTERFACE

# Put access before execution

Separate read scope from write scope and explain why each permission is requested.

CRM / READ

### Four lead fields

Name, company, role, and inquiry message for assigned leads. No phone number, private notes, or historical records.

SLACK / DRAFT

### One channel only

Prepare one draft in #sales-leads. Posting is blocked until a teammate approves the exact message.

NOT REQUESTED

### No broad write scope

No CRM edits, private Slack reading, lead messaging, or auto-posting. Unneeded access stays off.

BEFORE THE USER CONTINUES

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Permission | App, action, field scope, reason, and duration | Preview | Example output with data boundaries |
| Autonomy | What can run, pause, or needs approval | Removal | Where to disconnect or change access |

**Permission language describes an observable action, not a vague "connect account" request.**

05 / INTERFACE

# Trust is tested when something goes wrong

Replace a generic error with the cause, consequence, and a safe next step.

LOW CONFIDENCE

### Pause the lead

Show the missing field and the criterion it affects. Ask for review, not a guess.

NEXT: INSPECT / EDIT / RETRY / REJECT

CONNECTION EXPIRED

### No write occurred

Name the disconnected app and affected step. Reconnect, then retry that step.

NEXT: INSPECT / EDIT / RETRY / REJECT

DUPLICATE FOUND

### Skip safely

Show the matching record and why it matched. Do not create a second post.

NEXT: INSPECT / EDIT / RETRY / REJECT

WRONG SUMMARY

### Keep it private

Edit the draft or rule, preview again, reject, or pause the workflow.

NEXT: INSPECT / EDIT / RETRY / REJECT

# Prototype the trust-critical transitions

A runnable single-file clickthrough demonstrates the route and its control points.

01
### Prompt
Understand what Pucho inferred?

→

02
### Plan
Edit rules; distinguish AI from logic?

→

03
### Access
Identify data read and action written?

→

04
### Preview
Predict what will and will not happen?

→

05
### Run
Inspect, approve, reject, or pause?

INTERACTION
### Editable criteria
Open the fit rule and see uncertainty handling before proceeding.

INTERACTION
### Permission review
Inspect read and draft scopes; confirm summary to continue.

INTERACTION
### Run + approval
Review a low-confidence sample; approve or keep private.

**Open Pucho_AI_Clickthrough_Prototype.html. No server, account, external asset, or integration required.**

07 / VALIDATE

# Test trust as behaviour, not as a feeling

Three tasks ask users to predict, inspect, correct, and recover. Study is prepared, not run.

TASK 01

## Build from an outcome

Set up a weekday lead summary; decide what happens when AI is unsure.

LOOK FOR

Can the participant reach a plan without platform vocabulary?

TASK 02

## Inspect plan and access

Explain what the workflow reads, writes, and still needs approved. Change anything you would not allow.

LOOK FOR

Can they identify fields, destination, AI vs rule, and approval?

TASK 03

## Recover safely

A lead lacks details and Slack needs reconnection. Decide what to do next.

LOOK FOR

Do they prevent an unsafe post and find safe recovery?

STUDY STATUS

Recruit five operations or sales-ops practitioners with little automation experience. Use fictional data, obtain note-taking consent, and do not coach during tasks.

07 / VALIDATE

# Decide what to change before sessions

Proposed diagnostic targets for an initial qualitative round, not observed results.

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| COMPLETION | 4/5 | Complete each task without facilitator intervention. |
| PLAN RECALL | 4/5 | Explain trigger, source, AI decision, destination, and approval. |
| SCOPE RECALL | 5/5 | Name each read/write permission and reason before consent. |
| UNSAFE ASSUMPTION | 0 | No one believes the sample posted or can post without approval. |
| RECOVERY | 4/5 | Find a safe next step after uncertainty or connection failure. |

**Iteration order: unsafe assumptions first, comprehension blockers second, speed and visual refinement after.**

08 / OUTCOME

# Every design choice has a reason

Connect public evidence, an explicit hypothesis, a decision, and a test.

**EVIDENCE**

Pucho presents agents, workflows, integrations, knowledge, and checkpoints.

→

**HYPOTHESIS**

A first-time operator may need outcome language and predictable control.

→

**DECISION**

Reveal the plan, data scope, and action consequences progressively.

→

**DESIGN**

Ask -> plan -> access -> preview -> run -> approve or recover.

→

**VALIDATION**

Test comprehension, safe prediction, and recovery with participants.

**PORTFOLIO LESSON**

**For AI UX, the design system is also a trust system. Make actions legible, preserve human checkpoints, and help people recover when a model or tool is uncertain.**

Outcome: concept and prototype complete. Empirical evidence and impact remain to be established.

APPENDIX / SOURCES

# Sources, assumptions, and research integrity

Public product information is evidence about positioning, not evidence about user behaviour.

## OFFICIAL PUBLIC SOURCES REVIEWED / 27 OCT 2026

**Pucho product overview**
https://www.pucho.ai/product-overview

**Pucho AI Agents**
https://www.pucho.ai/ai-agents

**Pucho AI Workflows**
https://www.pucho.ai/ai-workflows

**Pucho product documentation**
https://www.pucho.ai/documentation/product-overview/pucho-platform

**Zapier approval steps**
https://help.zapier.com/hc/en-us/articles/41776074420493-Add-approval-steps-to-your-agent-s-instructions

**Make scenario types**
https://help.make.com/whats-a-scenario-and-which-type-should-you-use

**n8n AI agents**
https://n8n.io/ai-agents/

**n8n workflow features**
https://n8n.io/features/

### ASSUMPTIONS

Nisha is a proto-persona. Needs are hypotheses. UI is a concept redesign. Metrics are proposed. Participant testing was not conducted.

### INTEGRITY NOTE

No interviews, quotes, usability findings, or performance outcomes were fabricated. The validation kit prepares a runnable study.